

all come together to form a proper memory that's stored in your brain.

That said, technology has allowed us to store thousands of people's contacts and have them a mere voice command away, yet if we lost our phones we might not even remember our best friend's phone number! It's not just calling, which none of us do anymore anyway, it's birthdays, general calendar events, TTD lists and more that we just end up delegating to our gadgets to remind us about, because we cannot be expected to remember things like that.

Now, if we were remembering hundreds of other facts in place of all

firm believers in the PC master race concept, despite the similarities in terminology used by a certain mustached war criminal who caused WWII. We cannot help but be this way because we're gamers at heart, and the mouse and keyboard are sacred input devices that we swear by. It's what gives us the ability to easily vanquish the console peasants with ease, unless they cheat and use aim assist.

Of course, it's not just gaming that we love the good old mouse and keyboard for... pretty much any serious technology creation has R&D done and loads of lines of code tapped out

from flying on to the shelves, including weird looking devices purpose built for not just gaming but specific games. Then there are the odd shaped mice that want you to hold them like joysticks in the name of ergonomics, or keyboards that look more like the Battlestar Galactica than an input device...

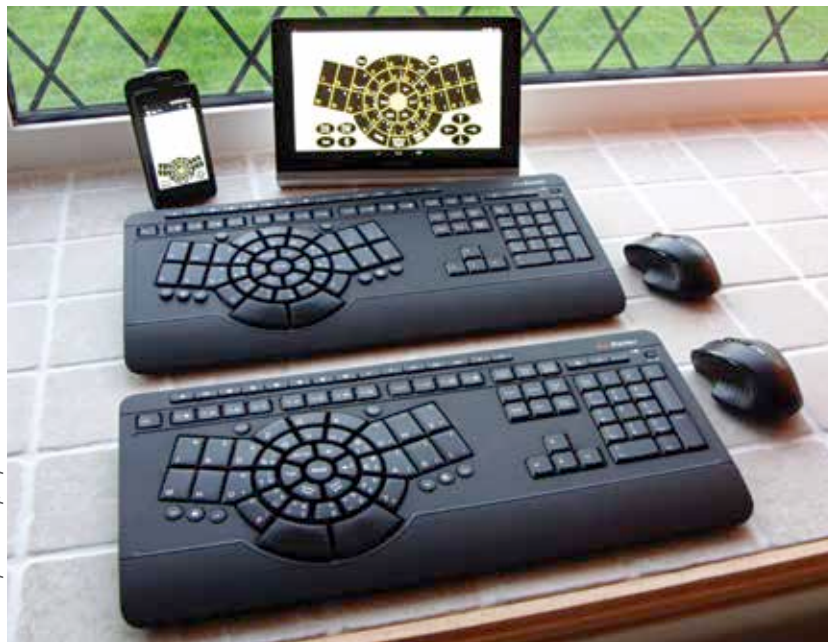
■ PENMANSHIP / WRITING

While we're moaning about input methods, let's jump a few millennia backwards and look at the original input device... the pen. Or pencil, or quill, or whatever instrument you fancy. For so many of us these days, just filling out a form in block letters is a chore, so writing out a letter or anything longer than a sentence or two seems like an alien concept. In fact, for many of us, a pen is only used to sign our names, or to take down complaint numbers while we're talking on our phones to some customer service representative.

Think back to school, and how much time you spent trying to improve your handwriting, and how much time the teachers would spend with you giving you feedback and grading you on that skill. Now look at the complaint number you wrote out on that paper, and ask yourself if you're still proud of that hard work you did in school.

For many of us, writing things down forces us to think about what we're saying, and as a result we're actually better at writing out something instead of just saying it. While texting and using a keyboard might still improve what you say over just blurting out thoughts as and when they pop into your head, studies have proven that writing by hand actually aids in new memory formation. A 2017 study published in *Frontiers in Psychology* found that the parts of your brain associated with learning lit up much more when actually writing out things by hand, as opposed to typing them out on a keyboard. Students who took notes by hand were found to have a better understanding of a lesson than those who took notes on laptops.

Not only is it good for your mem-



Credit: Ray Mcenaney/ozy.com

Anathema

of these then perhaps that would be fine, but do we? What was the last informative documentary you watched, and what did it teach you? Can you remember 5 facts that you learned from that documentary and write it down? And if you did remember all of that, can you now Google to see if those facts were remembered correctly? If you pass all of these tasks, you might have nothing to worry about, and are among the lucky few who are still keeping their brains in good enough shape. The rest of us are not that lucky!

■ MICE AND KEYBOARDS

We're PC purists here at Digit, and

on a good old fashioned keyboard. Whether you're creating software, editing videos, touching up images, designing a building, writing a research paper, or typing out an article like the one you're reading right now, it's almost always created by using the good old mouse and keyboard combination that we PC users still swear by.

Sticking to a tried and trusted design and not introducing innovation that can be patented is the antithesis of capitalist market teachings, so of course we had to take the simple mouse and keyboard and "improve them". Did we? Of course not, but that didn't stop a million new designs